IT Support & Security Policy

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Owner: IT Support Department, Northwind Dynamics Ltd.

1. Scope and Support Hours

This policy governs the use of company IT systems, devices and accounts, and describes how employees obtain support. It applies to all employees and contractors.

1.1 Service Desk Hours

The IT Service Desk operates Monday to Friday, 08:00 to 18:00. Priority 1 (P1) incidents are handled 24 hours a day, 7 days a week through the on-call line (ext. 3999). Tickets are raised through the self-service portal at help.northwind.example or by emailing it-help@northwind.example.

1.2 Responsibilities

Employees must keep their devices secure, report incidents promptly, and use company systems only for authorised purposes. IT is responsible for provisioning, patching and monitoring.

2. Accounts and Password Policy

Requirement	Rule
Minimum length	14 characters
Rotation	Every 90 days
Multi-factor authentication	Mandatory for all accounts
Account lockout	After 5 failed sign-in attempts
Password reuse	Last 12 passwords cannot be reused

2.1 Password Reset

Locked accounts can be unlocked through the self-service portal using MFA. If MFA is unavailable, the employee must contact the Service Desk and verify identity through their manager. Password reset requests are never accepted by email alone.

2.2 Remote Access and VPN

Employees working remotely must connect through the company VPN to reach internal systems. VPN access is enabled by default for employees approved for hybrid or remote work by HR. Public Wi-Fi may be used only through the VPN.

2.3 Account Lifecycle

Accounts for new starters are created before the start date once HR submits the onboarding request. Accounts of leavers are disabled at 18:00 on their last working day.

3. Hardware and Devices

3.1 Standard Equipment

Each employee is issued one laptop, one monitor and a headset. Laptops are refreshed every 36 months. Additional peripherals must be requested through the portal and justified by the line manager.

3.2 Lost or Stolen Devices

A lost or stolen device must be reported to the Service Desk within 24 hours. IT will remotely lock and wipe the device. Thefts must additionally be reported to local police and a copy of the report provided to IT.

3.3 Damage and Replacement

Accidental damage is assessed by IT. Replacement is free the first time within a 36-month cycle. Repeated damage may be referred to the line manager and Finance for cost recovery. The cost of purchasing replacement equipment is covered by Finance policy.

3.4 Personal Devices (BYOD)

Personal mobile phones may access email and calendar only after enrolment in Mobile Device Management (MDM). Personal laptops are not permitted to connect to internal systems.

3.5 Home Office Equipment

Equipment purchased by employees with the home office stipend remains the employee's property and is not supported by IT. Company-issued laptops are supported wherever they are used.

4. Software and Services

4.1 Standard Software Catalogue

Software in the approved catalogue is installed within 2 business days of request. The catalogue includes office suite, collaboration tools, PDF editor, and VPN client.

4.2 Non-Standard Software

Software outside the catalogue requires a security review, which takes up to 10 business days. If the software has a licence cost above $500, written Finance approval must be attached to the request.

4.3 Prohibited Software

Peer-to-peer file sharing, unlicensed software and unauthorised remote administration tools are prohibited.

4.4 Data Backup and Retention

Files stored on company cloud drives are backed up nightly and retained for 30 days after deletion. Files stored only on local laptop drives are not backed up.

4.5 Printing

Printers are available on each floor. Colour printing is limited to marketing and finance departments.

5. Incident Management and SLAs

Priority	Definition	First response	Target resolution
P1 - Critical	Company-wide outage or security breach	1 hour	4 hours
P2 - High	Department-level outage	4 hours	1 business day
P3 - Medium	Single user cannot work	1 business day	3 business days
P4 - Low	Minor issue or request	3 business days	5 business days

5.1 Security Incidents

Suspected phishing, malware or data loss must be reported immediately to security@northwind.example. Do not forward suspicious emails to colleagues.

5.2 Escalation

If an SLA is breached, the employee may escalate to the IT Support Manager via the portal. Compensation for downtime is not provided under this policy.

6. Contacts and Revision History

Topic	Contact
Service Desk	it-help@northwind.example (ext. 3000)
P1 on-call line	ext. 3999
Security team	security@northwind.example (ext. 3100)

Revision History

Version	Date	Change
2.3	1 Jan 2025	MFA made mandatory for all accounts
2.4	1 Jan 2026	Password length raised from 12 to 14; laptop refresh set to 36 months

This document is fictional and was created for a RAG training assignment.